

Meeting report:

Expert Team on Climate Data Development and Stewardship (**ET-DDS**)
Standing Committee on Climate Services (SC-CLI)
SERCOM

27 May 2026, 13:00 – 15:00 Geneva time

References

Github: <https://github.com/ET-DRC>

General Wiki: <https://github.com/ET-DRC/Home/wiki>

DAYCLI Wiki: <https://github.com/ET-DRC/DAYCLI-message/wiki>

Shared drive, available at:

<https://community.wmo.int/en/governance/commission-membership/sercom-management-group/standing-committee-climate-services/expert-team-climate-data-development-and-stewardship>

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Participants:

Name	P*	Name	P*	Name	P*
Mr Alessandro Spinuso	P	Mr Jose Guijarro	P	Ms Sandhya Dindyal	
Mr Ali Eddenjal		Mr Markus ZIESE		Mr Tursyn Tillakarim,	
Mr Axel Andersson	P	Mr Peer Hechler		Mr Urip Haryoko	
Ms Cathy Smith		Mr Rachid Sebbari		Mr William Wright	P
Mr Denis Stuber	P	Mr Reinaldo Silveira	P	Mr Byungjun Kim	P
Ms Ge Peng	P	Mr Robert Dunn	P		

*P: Present

Notes: actions and agreements highlighted in **bold**.

Invited: Qingchen Chao (Chair SC-CLI), Blair Trewin (SC-CLI/ET-MCCVC) and Dave Berry (WMO)

1 Monsoon Conference WMO/CMA

Presentation by Qingchen Chao of the “Enabling Elements for Climate Services Support the implementation of Monsoon Research and Climate Operation” at the Open Monsoon Conference the 18/05/2026. See at [【主旨 6】Climate service \(Qingchen Chao\)](#)

2 Extremes indices action with ET-MCCVC

Blair Trewin (ET-MCCVC) presented the project of defining a new generation of indices in collaboration with ET-DDS.

“Towards a New Generation of Climate Metrics” presented during the homogenization seminar [https://www.met.hu/en/rolunk/rendezvenyek/index.php?id=3612&hir=12th Seminar for Homogenization and Quality Control in Climatological Databases and 7th Interpolation Conference followed by the Danube-Adapt Project meeting](https://www.met.hu/en/rolunk/rendezvenyek/index.php?id=3612&hir=12th_Seminar_for_Homogenization_and_Quality_Control_in_Climatological_Databases_and_7th_Interpolation_Conference_followed_by_the_Danube-Adapt_Project_meeting)

3 Homogenization seminar

Robert Dunn, Blair Trewin and Jose Guijarro gave a summary of the 12th Seminar for homogenization and quality Control in Climatological Databases that was held on 5-8 May 2026 in Budapest. See at [12th Seminar for Homogenization and Quality Control in Climatological Databases and 7th Interpolation Conference followed by the Danube-Adapt Project meeting - Conferences - met.hu](#).

The presentation from SC-CLI (ET-MCCVC and ET-DDS) is available here: https://www.met.hu/downloads.php?fn=/doc/rendezvenyek/Homogenization_2026/program/20260505/ET-DDS_WMO.pdf

The result of the survey on the consultation on homogenization directed by ET-DDS is available at: https://www.met.hu/downloads.php?fn=/doc/rendezvenyek/Homogenization_2026/program/20260505/Jose_A-Guijarro_WMOsurvey.pdf

4 ET-IM latest news

Ms Peng gave the last news on the 2 subgroups of INFCOM/SC-IMT/ET-IM:

- **Sub-Group 1:** Harmonization of the standard and recommended practices related to climate data and observations across the Technical Regulations. **WMO-No. 1238.**
- **Sub-Group 2:** Identify and prioritize essential functional requirements for a climate data management system (CDMS) based on the revised CDMS specifications (WMO-No. 1131).

See: <https://github.com/wmo-im/et-im>

Status: both projects should be finalized for July 2026, for endorsement at INFCOM-4 (November 2026), following by approval by the WMO Executive Council.

5 Exchange on SMM-CD with expert groups

Task team on Global Hydrological Data Centres TT-GloHyDaC, HydroSOS.

Due to the absence of Markus Ziese, this topic is postponed to our next meeting.

- ➔ Peer proposed to combine the discussion of this topic with the implementation of the Astana outputs regarding the road map for the SMM-CD implementation (including data catalogues and SMM-CD implementation for ET-MCCVC and State of the Climate (SoC) reporting.

6 AI Data Rescue and EUMETNET: Quality on Climate Data

Contact with EUMETNET Working Group on Automated QC for the Guidelines on Surface Station Data Quality Control and Quality Assurance for Climate Applications submissions / inputs into the next review of WMO 1269? -> meeting to plan with this Working Group.

Adam Barber, Chair of EUMetnet WG on Automated QC, has offered to contribute insights into any future revision of WMO-No 1269 (QC of surface climate data, a publication from a previous iteration of the current ET-DDS). William, who edited the current version of WMO-No 1269 which was based heavily on the current Australian BoM approach, supported this, and expressed his belief that such an update should be part of a future ET-DDS Workplan.

7 AI Data Rescue

A half day seminar in association with UK Water's "Climate Plans" described emerging efforts to apply AI and OCR approaches to digitisation of original manuscripts, to increase access to historical climate records.

A number of UK-based University research projects, many of them PhD topics, are being established, aiming to apply artificial learning approaches to the difficult and chronically under-resourced subject of digitising historical records. The approaches generally rely on training AI models on how to read manuscripts, and extending these to new manuscripts. While many of these are in the formative stages, some projects are achieving promising results; for instance one project applied an ensemble approach of three leading AI packages (SmolLM, Google Gemini and IBM Granite) to digitisation based on a learning dataset of 100-1000 manuscripts, achieving 97-99% accuracy. A key recommendation from the seminar was to produce a shared compendium of approaches (eg share code and experiential learnings) to accelerate progress (an approach that might be recommended for other climate data-related development topics, such as CDMS development).

8 Data Rescue project: Assistance to Libya

Meeting planned in July with the with University of "Politecnico di Milano" and University of "Degli Studi di Milano".

- The Team agreed on setting up a special meeting on this topic. A subgroup with DWD, UK Met Office and Météo-France could be established.

9 ET-DDS at ACRE 2026

WMO activities on Data Rescue has to be there. ET-DDS may update the presentation delivered during the "Earth System Modeling and Observations (ESMO)" in December 2025.

ACRE 2026 website: <https://aisam.eu/acre2026/>. 16-18 September 2026.

10 Climate services for WMO-No. 49

The section on Climate Services to be added to WMO-No. 49 has been postponed by SERCOM. This could be proposed for consideration at SERCOM-5 in 2028.

11 Next consultation

Reinaldo has presented a possible structure for the consultation on Maturity Matrixes.

Consultation on Climate Data Stewardship

Structure (according to previous consultation)

1. Introduction and presentation of the agenda
2. Climate Data Stewardship: context; definitions; components of stewardship; importance; applications (research and operation); examples; WMO SMM-CD; references
3. Usage (ECMWF, NOAA, WMO, etc.)
4. Use Case: Regional Climate Centres (RA-VI, Caribbean, Pacific, Astana (?))
5. Use Case: Global Datasets used in the SoC report
6. How to implement the WMO SMM-CD
7. Discussion
8. Conclusion
9. Survey
10. Questions and Answers (Q&A)

Actions: identify speakers, contact RCCs/NHMSs, translation, prepare Q&A, recording videos, etc.

12 DAYCLI

Draft of the DAYCLI guidelines has been finalized (William and Denis)
SC-CLI launched the review of the DAYCLI guidelines to a set of experts around the world.

Your review by 19 June is very welcome!

Possibility to present the DAYCLI guidelines during a side event at SERCOM-4.

13 News on ET-DDS (Reinaldo and Denis)

Since our last meeting, there have been several important developments regarding the future of ET-DDS.

We had discussions with Sena, Vice-President of SERCOM, as well as exchanges with SC-IMT, represented by Rémy Giraud. Based on these discussions, we provided a structured analysis of ET-DDS functions and activities, highlighting their strong link with climate expertise, climate services and Members' needs. In particular, we developed a table entitled "Structured functional ET-DDS mapping aligned with SC-CLI responsibilities".

No technical concerns were raised regarding this analysis. On the contrary, it was acknowledged that ET-DDS work is coherent, with no significant duplication with INFCOM, and that effective collaboration mechanisms already exist, for example on DAYCLI, WMO-No. 1238 and CDMS. This confirms the complementarity between climate expertise (SERCOM) and technical implementation (INFCOM).

However, the discussion has now evolved from a technical level to a governance level. The question is no longer only about activities, but about how functions and responsibilities are shared between SERCOM and INFCOM.

The current direction is therefore to clarify functions and responsibilities first, before considering any possible redistribution of activities.

The Team noted that ET-DDS continues to deliver a substantial programme of work in 2026 and has several planned activities extending into 2027.

ET-CDC: Expert Team on Capacity Development for Climate Services and Communication. Co-chairs: Wassila Thiaw (USA) and Charlotte McBride (South Africa).

ET-MCCVC: Expert Team on Monitoring and Communication Climate Variability and Change

ET-CIDS: Expert Team on Climate Services Information Systems for Decision Support

14 Date of next meeting

8 July 2026 13:00-15:00 Geneva Time (Axel and Robert not present)

15 Coming events

- ✓ **June 2026:** Executive Council EC-80 - Technical Coordination Committee (TCC) and Policy Advisory Committee (PAC): <https://meetings.wmo.int/ec-80/SitePages/Session%20Information.aspx>
- ✓ **16-18 September 2026:** ACRE, [Atmospheric Circulation Reconstructions over the Earth](#) (Rome)
- ✓ **October 2026:** SERCOM-4
- ✓ **November 2026:** INFCOM-4
- ✓ **January 2027:** Executive Council 81
- ✓ **Early 2028:** SERCOM-5